CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 5: **The Rock and the Sea** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Choose the sentence in the passive voice: 1

(a) The waves wore down the cliffs. **(b)** The cliffs stood tall.
(c) The waves are strong. **(d)** The cliffs were worn down by the waves.

2. If the Sea represents time, the Rock's resistance is best compared to a person who: 1

(a) refuses to change with the times **(b)** moves often
(c) loves travelling **(d)** learns quickly

3. A fair criticism of the Rock's stance is that it: 1

(a) is too humble
(b) lacks courage
(c) ignores that nothing stays unchanged forever
(d) is too generous

4. Which of the following is a metaphor? 1

(a) The Sea sounds like thunder. **(b)** The Sea is loud.
(c) The Sea is a patient sculptor. **(d)** The Sea is as deep as night.

5. Which word best describes the Sea's attitude? 1

(a) panicky **(b)** unhurried **(c)** jealous **(d)** bitter

6. Which tone is NOT found in the poem? 1

(a) playfulness **(b)** mocking cruelty **(c)** pride **(d)** calm confidence

7. Which question would a critic ask about the poem? 1

(a) Is the Sea's victory presented as fair? **(b)** Is the poem in French?
(c) How many fish are there? **(d)** Who built the harbour?

8. The shift from the Rock's stanzas to the Sea's stanzas marks a shift from: 1

(a) sea to land only **(b)** boast to reply
(c) past to future only **(d)** joy to grief

9. Which value is the poem most likely to promote? 1

(a) humility and adaptability **(b)** laziness
(c) fear **(d)** vanity

10. 'Both Rock and Sea are essential to coastlines.' This idea, compared with the poem, is: 1

(a) the poem's main message **(b)** an extension that adds balance
(c) irrelevant to nature **(d)** contradicted by every line

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Is the poem entirely pessimistic about the Rock? Explain. 2

12. Why is the Rock's admiration of the Sea's beauty significant? 2

13. Why is the Sea described as playful rather than angry? 2

14. How does the poem connect with the idea of 'impermanence'? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss whether the Rock is a hero or a fool. 3

16. Does the poem suggest that firmness is always bad? Argue. 3

17. Compare this poem's idea of strength with the idea of 'perseverance'. 3

OR

How does the dialogue form make the poem more effective? 3

18. How can the Rock's stance be seen as a form of pride in identity? 3

OR

If you were the Rock, how might you reply to the Sea? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Analyse how the poet makes an abstract idea (time) concrete. 5

OR

'Patience is a greater power than force.' Justify using the poem and your own experience. 5

20. Examine the structure of the poem and how it builds the argument. 5

OR

Imagine the poem is extended with a stanza from a third speaker, the Shore. Write a note on what the Shore might say. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND